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1 Paul and Timothy, servants of Christ Jesus, To all the saints in Christ Jesus at Philippi, together with the overseers and deacons: [2] Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. [3] I thank my God every time I remember you. [4] In every prayer for all of you, I always pray with joy, [5] because of your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now, [6] being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus. [7] It is right for me to feel this way about all of you, since I have you in my heart. For in my chains and in my defense and confirmation of the gospel, you are all partners in grace with me. [8] God is my witness how I long for all of you with the affection of Christ Jesus. [9] And this is my prayer: that your love may abound more and more in knowledge and depth of insight, [10] so that you may be able to test and prove what is best and may be pure and blameless for the day of Christ, [11] filled with the fruit of righteousness that comes through Jesus Christ, to the glory and praise of God. [12] Now I want you to know, brothers, that my circumstances have actually served to advance the gospel. [13] As a result, it has become clear throughout the whole palace guard and to everyone else that I am in chains for Christ. [14] And most of the brothers, confident in the Lord by my chains, now dare more greatly to speak the word without fear.

[15] It is true that some preach Christ out of envy and rivalry, but others out of goodwill. [16] The latter do so in love, knowing that I am appointed for the defense of the gospel. [17] The former, however, preach Christ out of selfish ambition, not sincerely, supposing that they can add to the distress of my chains. [18] What then is the issue? Just this: that in every way, whether by false motives or true, Christ is preached. And in this I rejoice. Yes, and I will continue to rejoice, [19] because I know that through your prayers and the provision of the Spirit of Jesus Christ, my distress will turn out for my deliverance.

[20] I eagerly expect and hope that I will in no way be ashamed, but will have complete boldness so that now as always Christ will be exalted in my body, whether by life or by death. [21] For to me, to live is Christ, and to die is gain. [22] But if I go on living in the body, this will mean fruitful labor for me. So what shall I choose? I do not know. [23] I am torn between the two. I desire to depart and be with Christ, which is far better indeed. [24] But it is more necessary for you that I remain in the body. [25] Convinced of this, I know that I will remain and will continue with all of you for your progress and joy in the faith, [26] so that through my coming to you again your exultation in Christ Jesus will resound on account of me. [27] Nevertheless, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ. Then, whether I come and see you or only hear about you in my absence, I will know that you stand firm in one spirit, contending side by side for the faith of the gospel, [28] without being frightened in any way by those who oppose you. This is a clear sign of their destruction but of your salvation, and it is from God. [29] For it has been granted to you on behalf of Christ not only to believe in Him, but also to suffer for Him, [30] since you are encountering the same struggle you saw I had, and now hear that I still have.

2 Therefore if you have any encouragement in Christ, if any comfort from His love, if any fellowship with the Spirit, if any affection and compassion, [2] then make my joy complete by being like-minded, having the same love, being united in spirit and purpose. [3] Do nothing out of selfish ambition or empty pride, but in humility consider others more important than yourselves. [4] Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others. [5] Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus: [6] Who, existing in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped, [7] but emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in human likeness. [8] And being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself and became obedient to death— even death on a cross. [9] Therefore God exalted Him to the highest place and gave Him the name above all names, [10] that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth, [11] and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father. [12] Therefore, my beloved, just as you have always obeyed, not only in my presence, but now even more in my absence, continue to work out your salvation with fear and trembling. [13] For it is God who works in you to will and to act on behalf of His good purpose. [14] Do everything without complaining or arguing, [15] so that you may be blameless and pure, children of God without fault in a crooked and perverse generation, in which you shine as lights in the world [16] as you hold forth the word of life, in order that I may boast on the day of Christ that I did not run or labor in vain. [17] But even if I am being poured out like a drink offering on the sacrifice and service of your faith, I am glad and rejoice with all of you. [18] So you too should be glad and rejoice with me. [19] Now I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy to you soon, that I also may be cheered when I learn how you are doing.

[20] I have nobody else like him who will genuinely care for your needs. [21] For all the others look after their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ.

[22] But you know Timothy's proven worth, that as a child with his father he has served with me to advance the gospel. [23] So I hope to send him as soon as I see what happens with me. [24] And I trust in the Lord that I myself will come soon. [25] But I thought it necessary to send back to you Epaphroditus, my brother, fellow worker, and fellow soldier, who is also your messenger and minister to my needs. [26] For he has been longing for all of you and is distressed because you heard he was ill. [27] He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow. [28] Therefore I am all the more eager to send him, so that when you see him again you may rejoice, and I may be less anxious. [29] Welcome him in the Lord with great joy, and honor men like him, [30] because he nearly died for the work of Christ, risking his life to make up for your deficit of service to me.

3 Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord. It is no trouble for me to write the same things to you again, and it is a safeguard for you. [2] Watch out for those dogs, those workers of evil, those mutilators of the flesh! [3] For it is we who are the circumcision, we who worship by the Spirit of God, who glory in Christ Jesus, and who put no confidence in the flesh— [4] though I myself could have such confidence. If anyone else thinks he has grounds for confidence in the flesh, I have more: [5] circumcised on the eighth day, of the people of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin; a Hebrew of Hebrews; as to the law, a Pharisee; [6] as to zeal, persecuting the church; as to righteousness in the law, faultless.

[7] But whatever was gain to me I count as loss for the sake of Christ. [8] More than that, I count all things as loss compared to the surpassing excellence of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord, for whom I have lost all things. I consider them rubbish, that I may gain Christ [9] and be found in Him, not having my own righteousness from the law, but that which is through faith in Christ, the righteousness from God on the basis of faith. [10] I want to know Christ and the power of His resurrection and the fellowship of His sufferings, being conformed to Him in His death, [11] and so, somehow, to attain to the resurrection from the dead. [12] Not that I have already obtained all this, or have already been made perfect, but I press on to take hold of that for which Christ Jesus took hold of me. [13] Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, [14] I press on toward the goal to win the prize of God's heavenly calling in Christ Jesus.

[15] All of us who are mature should embrace this point of view. And if you think differently about some issue, God will reveal this to you as well. [16] Nevertheless, we must live up to what we have already attained. [17] Join one another in following my example, brothers, and carefully observe those who walk according to the pattern we set for you. [18] For as I have often told you before, and now say again even with tears: Many live as enemies of the cross of Christ. [19] Their end is destruction, their god is their belly, and their glory is in their shame. Their minds are set on earthly things. [20] But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, [21] who, by the power that enables Him to subject all things to Himself, will transform our lowly bodies to be like His glorious body.

4 Therefore, my brothers, whom I love and long for, my joy and crown, that is how you must stand firm in the Lord, my beloved. [2] I urge Euodia and Syntyche to agree with each other in the Lord. [3] Yes, and I ask you, my true yokefellow, to help these women who have labored with me for the gospel, along with Clement and the rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the Book of Life.

[4] Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! [5] Let your gentleness be apparent to all. The Lord is near. [6] Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God.

[7] And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

[8] Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things. [9] Whatever you have learned or received or heard from me, or seen in me, put it into practice. And the God of peace will be with you.

[10] Now I rejoice greatly in the Lord that at last you have revived your concern for me. You were indeed concerned, but you had no opportunity to show it. [11] I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances. [12] I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. [13] I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength. [14] Nevertheless, you have done well to share in my affliction.

[15] And as you Philippians know, in the early days of the gospel, when I left Macedonia, no church but you partnered with me in the matter of giving and receiving. [16] For even while I was in Thessalonica, you provided for my needs again and again. [17] Not that I am seeking a gift, but I am looking for the fruit that may be credited to your account. [18] I have all I need and more, now that I have received your gifts from Epaphroditus. They are a fragrant offering, an acceptable sacrifice, well-pleasing to God. [19] And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus. [20] To our God and Father be glory forever and ever. Amen. [21] Greet all the saints in Christ Jesus. The brothers who are with me send you greetings. [22] All the saints send you greetings, especially those from the household of Caesar. [23] The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and Timothy our brother, [2] To the saints and faithful brothers in Christ at Colossae: Grace and peace to

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you from God our Father. [3] We always thank God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, when we pray for you, [4] because we have heard about your faith in Christ Jesus and your love for all the saints— [5] the faith and love proceeding from the hope stored up for you in heaven, of which you have already heard in the word of truth, the gospel [6] that has come to you. All over the world this gospel is bearing fruit and growing, just as it has been doing among you since the day you heard it and truly understood the grace of God. [7] You learned it from Epaphras, our beloved fellow servant, who is a faithful minister of Christ on our behalf, [8] and who also informed us of your love in the Spirit.

[9] For this reason, since the day we heard about you, we have not stopped praying for you and asking God to fill you with the knowledge of His will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, [10] so that you may walk in a manner worthy of the Lord and may please Him in every way: bearing fruit in every good work, growing in the knowledge of God, [11] being strengthened with all power according to His glorious might so that you may have full endurance and patience, and joyfully [12] giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in the light. [13] He has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of His beloved Son, [14] in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins. [15] The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation.

[16] For in Him all things were created, things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities. All things were created through Him and for Him. [17] He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together. [18] And He is the head of the body, the church; He is the beginning and firstborn from among the dead, so that in all things He may have preeminence.

[19] For God was pleased to have all His fullness dwell in Him, [20] and through Him to reconcile to Himself all things, whether things on earth or things in heaven, by making peace through the blood of His cross. [21] Once you were alienated from God and were hostile in your minds, engaging in evil deeds. [22] But now He has reconciled you by Christ's physical body through death to present you holy, unblemished, and blameless in His presence— [23] if indeed you continue in your faith, established and firm, not moved from the hope of the gospel you heard, which has been proclaimed to every creature under heaven, and of which I, Paul, have become a servant. [24] Now I rejoice in my sufferings for you, and I fill up in my flesh what is lacking in regard to Christ's afflictions for the sake of His body, which is the church. [25] I became its servant by the commission God gave me to fully proclaim to you the word of God, [26] the mystery that was hidden for ages and generations but is now revealed to His saints. [27] To them God has chosen to make known among the Gentiles the glorious riches of this mystery, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory. [28] We proclaim Him, admonishing and teaching everyone with all wisdom, so that we may present everyone perfect in Christ. [29] To this end I also labor, striving with all His energy working powerfully within me.

2 For I want you to know how much I am struggling for you and for those at Laodicea, and for all who have not met me face to face, [2] that they may be encouraged in heart, knit together in love, and filled with the full riches of complete understanding, so that they may know the mystery of God, namely Christ, [3] in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. [4] I say this so that no one will deceive you by smooth rhetoric. [5] For although I am absent from you in body, I am present with you in spirit, and I delight to see your orderly condition and firm faith in Christ. [6] Therefore, just as you have received Christ Jesus as Lord, continue to walk in Him, [7] rooted and built up in Him, established in the faith as you were taught, and overflowing with thankfulness. [8] See to it that no one takes you captive through philosophy and empty deception, which are based on human tradition and the spiritual forces of the world rather than on Christ. [9] For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity dwells in bodily form. [10] And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority. [11] In Him you were also circumcised, in the putting off of your sinful nature, with the circumcision performed by Christ and not by human hands. [12] And having been buried with Him in baptism, you were raised with Him through your faith in the power of God, who raised Him from the dead.

[13] When you were dead in your trespasses and in the uncircumcision of your sinful nature, God made you alive with Christ. He forgave us all our trespasses, [14] having canceled the debt ascribed to us in the decrees that stood against us. He took it away, nailing it to the cross!

[15] And having disarmed the powers and authorities, He made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross. [16] Therefore let no one judge you by what you eat or drink, or with regard to a feast, a New Moon, or a Sabbath. [17] These are a shadow of the things to come, but the body that casts it belongs to Christ. [18] Do not let anyone who delights in false humility and the worship of angels disqualify you with speculation about what he has seen. Such a person is puffed up without basis by his unspiritual mind. [19] He has lost connection to the head, from whom the whole body, supported and knit together by its joints and ligaments, grows as God causes it to grow. [20] If you have died with Christ to the spiritual forces of the world, why, as though you still belonged to the world, do you submit to its regulations: [21] "Do not handle, do not taste, do not touch!"? [22] These will all perish with use, because they are based on human commands and teachings. [23] Such restrictions indeed have an appearance of wisdom, with their self-prescribed worship, their false humility, and their harsh treatment of the body; but they are of no value against the indulgence of the flesh.

3 Therefore, since you have been raised with Christ, strive for the things above, where Christ is seated at the right hand of God. [2] Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things. [3] For you died, and your life is now hidden with Christ in God. [4] When Christ, who is your life, appears, then you also will appear with Him in glory. [5] Put to death, therefore, the components of your earthly nature: sexual immorality, impurity, lust, evil desires, and greed, which is idolatry. [6] Because of these, the wrath of God is coming on the sons of disobedience. [7] When you lived among them, you also used to walk in these ways.

[8] But now you must put aside all such things as these: anger, rage, malice, slander, and filthy language from your lips. [9] Do not lie to one another, since you have taken off the old self with its practices, [10] and have put on the new self, which is being renewed in knowledge in the image of its Creator. [11] Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave, or free, but Christ is all and is in all.

[12] Therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, clothe yourselves with hearts of compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience. [13] Bear with one another and forgive any complaint you may have against someone else. Forgive as the Lord forgave you. [14] And over all these virtues put on love, which is the bond of perfect unity. [15] Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, for to this you were called as members of one body. And be thankful.

[16] Let the word of Christ richly dwell within you as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom, and as you sing psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs with gratitude in your hearts to God. [17] And whatever you do, in word or deed, do it all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through Him.

[18] Wives, submit to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord. [19] Husbands, love your wives and do not be harsh with them. [20] Children, obey your parents in everything, for this is pleasing to the Lord. [21] Fathers, do not provoke your children, so they will not become discouraged. [22] Slaves, obey your earthly masters in everything, not only to please them while they are watching, but with sincerity of heart and fear of the Lord. [23] Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men, [24] because you know that you will receive an inheritance from the Lord as your reward. It is the Lord Christ you are serving. [25] Whoever does wrong will be repaid for his wrong, and there is no favoritism.

4 Masters, supply your slaves with what is right and fair, since you know that you also have a Master in heaven. [2] Devote yourselves to prayer, being watchful and thankful, [3] as you pray also for us, that God may open to us a door for the word, so that we may proclaim the mystery of Christ, for which I am in chains. [4] Pray that I may declare it clearly, as I should. [5] Act wisely toward outsiders, redeeming the time. [6] Let your speech always be gracious, seasoned with salt, so that you may know how to answer everyone. [7] Tychicus will tell you all the news about me. He is a beloved brother, a faithful minister, and a fellow servant in the Lord. [8] I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know about us, and that he may encourage your hearts. [9] With him I am sending Onesimus, our faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They will tell you about everything here.

[10] My fellow prisoner Aristarchus sends you greetings, as does Mark the cousin of Barnabas. You have already received instructions about him: If he comes to you, welcome him. [11] Jesus, who is called Justus, also sends greetings. These are the only Jews among my fellow workers for the kingdom of God, and they have been a comfort to me. [12] Epaphras, who is one of you and a servant of Christ Jesus, sends you greetings. He is always wrestling in prayer for you, so that you may stand mature and fully assured in the full will of God. [13] For I testify about him that he goes to great pains for you and for those at Laodicea and Hierapolis. [14] Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings. [15] Greet the brothers in Laodicea, as well as Nympha and the church that meets at her house. [16] After this letter has been read among you, make sure that it is also read in the church of the Laodiceans, and that you in turn read the letter from Laodicea. [17] Tell Archippus: "See to it that you complete the ministry you have received in the Lord." [18] This greeting is in my own hand—Paul. Remember my chains. Grace be with you.

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